

SOUTHERN CROSS STRATEGIC HOLDINGS PTE LIMITED*Protecting People. Securing Progress.***K9 OPERATIONS POLICY****KIKORI DEVELOPMENT PROJECT (KDP)**

Gulf Province, Independent State of Papua New Guinea

*Covering Land Security, Border Security, Sea Marshal Security and Protective Security Detail (PSD)**In support of the Papua LNG Project — Gulf and Central Provinces*

Field	Detail
Document Title	K9 Operations Policy
Document Number	SCSH-SEC-K9-001
Version	Version 3.0 (supersedes Version 2.0 – 2026)
Classification	RESTRICTED – Internal Use and Authorised Clients Only
Applicable Operation	Kikori Development Project (KDP), Gulf Province, PNG
Document Owner	Group Manager – Integrated Security Solutions
Prepared By	K9 Unit Supervisor (Kennel Master), KDP
Reviewed By	KDP Security Operations Manager; Group HSSE Manager
Approved By	Managing Director, Southern Cross Strategic Holdings Pte Limited
Effective Date	___ / ___ / 2026
Next Scheduled Review	___ / ___ / 2027 (or earlier if triggered under Section 24)

Uncontrolled when printed. The authoritative version of this policy is the electronic copy held by the Document Controller, Southern Cross Strategic Holdings Pte Limited.

Document Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of Change	Authorised By
1.0	2026	Initial issue of the K9 Operations Policy for KDP.	K9 Unit Supervisor
2.0	2026	Comprehensive revision: legal and regulatory framework added; roles and responsibilities expanded into an accountability matrix; graduated use-of-force model introduced; tropical heat and fatigue management standards added; welfare provisions aligned to the Five Domains model; Section 12 (Community and Landowner Engagement) fully developed; biosecurity, retirement and rehoming, assurance, and non-compliance sections added; four annexes introduced.	Managing Director
3.0	2026	Alignment to the Papua LNG Project operating context and the current pre-Final-Investment-Decision environment; addition of international human-rights and security standards (VPSHR, IFC PS4, ICoC and related instruments); geographic scope updated to the Company's KDP site footprint; new guidance for benefit-sharing, Development Forum and heightened-sensitivity periods; definitions expanded.	Managing Director

Table of Contents

Document Revision History	2
Table of Contents	2
1.0 Purpose of Policy	5
1.1 Operating Context — The Papua LNG Project	5
2.0 Scope and Applicability	5
2.1 Persons Covered	5
2.2 Geographic and Operational Scope	5
2.3 Relationship to Other Company Documents	6
3.0 Definitions and Abbreviations	6
4.0 Legal and Regulatory Framework	7
4.1 International Standards and Human-Rights Frameworks	7
5.0 Policy Statement and Guiding Principles	8
5.1 Legality	8
5.2 Proportionality and Necessity	8
5.3 Control	8
5.4 Welfare	8

5.5 Cultural Respect	8
5.6 Accountability	8
5.7 Human Rights.....	9
6.0 Objectives of the K9 Programme.....	9
7.0 Governance, Command and Accountability	9
7.1 Reporting Lines.....	9
7.2 Chain of Command	9
7.3 Accountability Matrix.....	9
7.4 Segregation of Duties.....	10
8.0 K9 Operational Categories.....	10
8.1 Land Security K9 Deployment	10
8.2 Border Security K9 Deployment	10
8.3 Sea Marshal K9 Deployment.....	10
8.4 PSD K9 Deployment.....	11
9.0 K9 Team Composition and Eligibility	11
9.1 Handler Requirements.....	11
9.2 Dog Requirements.....	11
9.3 Team Pairing and Continuity.....	11
10.0 Acquisition, Onboarding and Contracted Providers.....	11
11.0 Training and Certification	12
11.1 Initial Training	12
11.2 Ongoing Training	12
11.3 Loss of Certification.....	12
11.4 Control of Training Aids.....	12
12.0 Operational Deployment Standards.....	12
12.1 General Rules	13
12.2 Duty Cycles, Heat and Fatigue Management.....	13
12.3 Safety Protocols.....	13
12.4 Transport.....	13
13.0 Use of Force and K9 Apprehension.....	14
13.1 Governing Principle.....	14
13.2 Graduated Response Model.....	14
13.3 Prohibited Uses	14
13.4 Post-Incident Obligations.....	14
14.0 Health, Welfare and Veterinary Care	15
14.1 Nutrition and Hydration	15
14.2 Veterinary Care	15
14.3 Behavioural and Psychological Welfare.....	15
14.4 Kennelling and Housing.....	15
15.0 Equipment and Logistics.....	15
16.0 Biosecurity and Disease Control.....	16

17.0 Incident Reporting, Investigation and Records	16
17.1 Reportable Events	16
17.2 Timeframes	16
17.3 Records	16
18.0 Community and Landowner Engagement	16
18.1 Prior Notification and Awareness	17
18.2 Conduct in and near Communities	17
18.3 Cultural Sensitivity	17
18.4 Grievance, Injury and Compensation	17
18.5 National Capability Development	17
18.6 Operating During Benefit-Sharing and Development Forum Periods	17
19.0 Confidentiality, Media and Information Security	18
20.0 Retirement, Rehoming and End of Service	18
21.0 Assurance, Audit and Performance Measurement	18
22.0 Non-Compliance and Disciplinary Action	19
23.0 Training and Communication of this Policy	19
24.0 Review Cycle	19
Approval and Authorisation	21
Annex A — K9 Deployment Authorisation Form	22
Annex B — K9 Bite and Use of Force Report	23
Annex C — Daily Kennel and Welfare Log	24
Annex D — Certification and Currency Matrix	25

1.0 Purpose of Policy

This policy establishes the mandatory standards governing the deployment, management, training, welfare, conduct and operational use of canine (K9) teams engaged by Southern Cross Strategic Holdings Pte Limited (“the Company”) in support of the Kikori Development Project (“KDP”).

The K9 capability is a specialist force multiplier that materially enhances detection, deterrence and response across all layers of the KDP security architecture. Specifically, the capability supports:

- Land Security — protection of project assets, staff compounds, laydown yards, construction areas, pipeline rights-of-way and access roads.
- Border Security — monitoring and interdiction along river borders, remote checkpoints, landing points and high-risk ingress routes.
- Sea Marshal Security — vessel screening, escort duties, anti-piracy support and maritime threat detection.
- Protective Security Detail (PSD) — VIP protection, advance venue sweeps, explosive detection, perimeter screening and escort support.

This policy further ensures that all K9 operations are conducted lawfully, humanely, proportionately and in a manner consistent with the laws of Papua New Guinea, contractual obligations to the client, recognised international working-dog standards, and the Company’s duty of care to its personnel, to the communities in which it operates, and to the animals in its charge.

1.1 Operating Context — The Papua LNG Project

The Kikori Development Project (KDP) forms part of the security effort supporting the Papua LNG Project, the TotalEnergies-operated development of the Elk and Antelope gas fields undertaken with ExxonMobil, Santos, JX Nippon and the Independent State of Papua New Guinea. The project’s gas-conditioning facilities, associated infrastructure and export pipeline corridor traverse customary land, rivers and coastal waters across Gulf Province and Central Province before connecting to liquefaction facilities in the National Capital District. The Company’s K9 capability is delivered within this corridor and shall be applied consistently with the project’s obligations to the State, to landowner communities, and to the project’s international partners and lenders.

At the date of this revision the Papua LNG Project is advancing toward its Final Investment Decision, and the State-convened Papua LNG Development Forum has brought landowners, the Gulf Provincial Government and the Central Provincial Government together to settle benefit-sharing and development commitments. This is a period of heightened community expectation and sensitivity across the project area. All K9 operations shall be conducted with acute awareness of this environment and in a manner that protects project personnel and assets while actively reducing — and never amplifying — the risk of community grievance.

2.0 Scope and Applicability

2.1 Persons Covered

This policy applies without exception to:

- All K9 handlers, senior handlers and trainers employed or engaged by the Company.
- Supervisors, team leaders, security managers and operations staff exercising authority over K9 teams.
- Contracted K9 service providers, sub-contractors and their personnel.
- All KDP security personnel working alongside, or in support of, K9 teams.
- Any Company, client, visitor or third-party personnel who interact with, or may foreseeably come into contact with, a Company K9.

2.2 Geographic and Operational Scope

This policy applies to all KDP operational areas in Gulf Province and adjoining provinces, including fixed sites, mobile patrols, river and coastal operations, marine bases, airstrips, checkpoints and any temporary location at which a Company K9 is deployed, transported, housed or exercised.

For the avoidance of doubt, the operational scope includes the Company's principal locations along the corridor — the Kerema headquarters and forward operating base; the Papua LNG facilities and their associated laydown, construction and pipeline right-of-way areas; the Kimu and Barikewa gas field sites; the Uramu Marine Base; and the river, bay, checkpoint and escort routes linking them — together with any vessel, vehicle or temporary post on which a Company K9 is tasked.

2.3 Relationship to Other Company Documents

This policy is a subordinate instrument of the Company's Integrated Security Solutions Policy and is to be read together with the documents listed below. Where a conflict arises, the more stringent requirement prevails.

- KDP Use of Force Policy
- Border Security Policy
- Zero-Tolerance Conduct, Ethics and Prohibited Behaviour Policy (SCSH-HR-GOV-001)
- Health, Safety, Security and Environment (HSSE) Management Plan
- Incident Management and Emergency Response Procedures
- Community and Landowner Engagement Framework
- Fixed-Term International Employment and PNG Deployment Contract

3.0 Definitions and Abbreviations

Term	Definition
K9	A dog trained, certified and deployed for a security, detection or patrol purpose under this policy.
Handler	A certified individual assigned sole operational custody of a specific K9 and accountable for its control, welfare and performance.
Kennel Master	The K9 Unit Supervisor holding day-to-day accountability for kennels, welfare, training standards and certification currency.
Detection K9	A K9 certified in the passive or active indication of a defined target odour (explosives, narcotics, firearms or currency).
Patrol K9	A K9 certified in tracking, area search, intruder detection and, where authorised, controlled apprehension.
Dual-Purpose K9	A K9 certified in both a detection discipline and patrol work.
Passive Indication	A trained, non-aggressive response (typically a sit or freeze) used for screening people and sensitive cargo.
Deployment Authority	The named appointment empowered under Section 10 to authorise a specific K9 task.
Apprehension / Bite	The trained physical engagement of a person by a patrol K9. Classified at all times as a use of force.
PSD	Protective Security Detail.
KDP	Kikori Development Project.
NASDU	National Association of Security Dog Users (United Kingdom).

Term	Definition
IGP / PSA	Internationale Gebrauchshund Prüfung; Protection Sports Association — recognised working-dog assessment standards.
ISPS Code	International Ship and Port Facility Security Code.
Five Domains	The internationally recognised animal welfare assessment model: nutrition, environment, health, behaviour and mental state.
VPSHR	Voluntary Principles on Security and Human Rights — the international framework for the conduct of security on extractive-industry projects.
ICoC	International Code of Conduct for Private Security Service Providers.
IFC PS4	International Finance Corporation Performance Standard 4 (Community Health, Safety and Security).
ILG	Incorporated Land Group — the registered vehicle through which customary landowners receive project benefits.
RPNGC	Royal Papua New Guinea Constabulary.
PNGDF	Papua New Guinea Defence Force.
WOAH	World Organisation for Animal Health (formerly OIE), the source of international standards on working-animal welfare.

4.0 Legal and Regulatory Framework

K9 operations shall be conducted in compliance with all applicable law and regulation of the Independent State of Papua New Guinea and, where relevant, of the Republic of Fiji as the jurisdiction of incorporation of the Company. Handlers and supervisors are responsible for operating within these instruments at all times.

- Security (Protection) Industry legislation and licensing requirements administered by the Security Industries Authority of Papua New Guinea.
- The Criminal Code Act of Papua New Guinea, in particular provisions relating to assault, self-defence, defence of property and lawful arrest.
- Animal welfare, veterinary and animal disease control legislation, together with National Agriculture Quarantine and Inspection Authority (NAQIA) import, quarantine and biosecurity requirements.
- Customs, firearms, narcotics and prohibited goods legislation governing the handling, storage and disposal of training aids and seized items.
- Maritime security requirements, including the ISPS Code and PNG Ports and National Maritime Safety Authority directions applicable to vessel and port-facility operations.
- Environment and wildlife protection legislation, including obligations relevant to the interdiction of protected species and CITES-listed material.
- Employment, occupational health and safety, and workers' compensation legislation applicable to handlers and supporting staff.

4.1 International Standards and Human-Rights Frameworks

Because the Company operates as a private security provider on a major extractive-industry project, K9 operations shall additionally be conducted in a manner consistent with the following international standards and good-practice frameworks:

- **The Voluntary Principles on Security and Human Rights (VPSHR)** — the primary international framework governing the conduct of public and private security in support of extractive operations, requiring documented security risk assessment, proportionate use of force, and respect for the human rights of individuals and communities.
- **IFC Performance Standard 4 — Community Health, Safety and Security** — together with the World Bank Group Environmental, Health and Safety Guidelines, reflecting the project's stated commitment to the IFC Performance Standards and the Equator Principles.
- **The UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights** — in relation to the Company's responsibility to respect human rights and to support access to remedy.
- **The International Code of Conduct for Private Security Service Providers (ICoC) and the Montreux Document** — governing the lawful, accountable and rules-based provision of private security services.
- **Recognised international animal-welfare standards** — including the Five Domains model and the principles of the World Organisation for Animal Health (WOAH) on the welfare of working dogs.
- **Client and project security requirements** — including any project-specific Security Management Plan and any memorandum of understanding governing coordination with the Royal Papua New Guinea Constabulary (RPNGC) and the Papua New Guinea Defence Force (PNGDF).

Nothing in this policy authorises any act that is unlawful. Where a lawful instruction conflicts with this policy, the law prevails and the matter shall be escalated immediately to the Security Operations Manager.

5.0 Policy Statement and Guiding Principles

The Company is committed to maintaining a professional, humane and legally defensible K9 capability. The following principles are binding on all personnel:

5.1 Legality

Every K9 deployment must have a lawful basis, a defined task and a documented authorisation.

5.2 Proportionality and Necessity

A K9 shall be deployed only where the operational benefit is proportionate to the risk posed to persons, animals and community relations, and only where a less intrusive measure would not reasonably achieve the objective.

5.3 Control

A K9 is a controlled asset, never an autonomous one. Positive physical and verbal control by a certified handler is required at all times.

5.4 Welfare

The Company regards its working dogs as assets held in trust. Welfare obligations under Section 14 are non-negotiable and are not subordinate to operational tempo.

5.5 Cultural Respect

K9 operations take place within landowner communities that hold their own relationships with, and perceptions of, dogs. Deployment shall be conducted with cultural awareness, prior engagement where practicable, and strict avoidance of any use that could reasonably be perceived as intimidation of a community.

5.6 Accountability

Every deployment, training session, welfare check and incident is recorded, auditable and attributable to a named individual.

5.7 Human Rights

All K9 activity shall respect the human rights and inherent dignity of every person, consistent with the Voluntary Principles on Security and Human Rights. Any use of a K9 involving force is a measure of last resort, is always proportionate to a genuine threat, and is never used to intimidate, punish, coerce or discriminate against any person or community.

6.0 Objectives of the K9 Programme

- Enhance detection capability across explosives, narcotics, weapons, contraband and human intrusion.
- Strengthen visible and covert deterrence across all project security layers.
- Support rapid response teams during critical incidents and emergency scenarios.
- Reduce physical risk to personnel by employing trained dogs for search tasks in hazardous or confined environments.
- Improve operational readiness across land, maritime and border environments.
- Enable PSD protection through proactive screening and early threat identification.
- Build a sustainable, nationally staffed K9 capability through structured PNG national handler development.
- Maintain a demonstrable record of humane, lawful and audit-ready K9 practice.

7.0 Governance, Command and Accountability

7.1 Reporting Lines

- K9 teams report operationally to the KDP Security Operations Manager.
- Day-to-day supervision, welfare and training assurance rest with the K9 Unit Supervisor (Kennel Master).
- PSD-assigned K9 teams coordinate tasking with the PSD Team Leader while remaining under the technical authority of the Kennel Master.
- Sea Marshal K9 teams coordinate tasking with the Maritime Security Coordinator on the same basis.

7.2 Chain of Command

Managing Director → Group Manager, Integrated Security Solutions → KDP Security Operations Manager → K9 Unit Supervisor (Kennel Master) → Senior Handler → Handler.

7.3 Accountability Matrix

Appointment	Core Accountabilities
Security Operations Manager	Owns the K9 capability at site level. Approves the deployment plan, authorises high-risk and PSD taskings, chairs incident reviews, and reports K9 performance and incidents to the client.
K9 Unit Supervisor (Kennel Master)	Accountable for kennel standards, welfare, veterinary liaison, training programme delivery, certification currency, equipment serviceability, records integrity and handler competency assessment.
Senior Handler	Supervises shift-level deployment, conducts pre-deployment checks, mentors handlers, and provides first-line quality control of search technique and reporting.
Handler	Accountable for the control, condition, welfare, daily care, training currency and lawful employment of the assigned K9, and for accurate completion of all logs and reports.

Appointment	Core Accountabilities
PSD Team Leader / Maritime Security Coordinator	Defines the operational task, provides the threat picture and site brief, and integrates the K9 team into the wider protective or maritime plan.
HSSE Manager	Assures safety compliance, investigates bite and injury events, and maintains bite-injury and zoonotic exposure reporting.
Community Liaison Officer	Delivers community notification and awareness activity, receives K9-related grievances, and advises on cultural sensitivities affecting deployment.
Attending Veterinarian	Provides scheduled and emergency clinical care, certifies fitness for duty, and endorses welfare standards at each inspection.

7.4 Segregation of Duties

No individual shall simultaneously authorise a deployment, conduct it, and sign off the associated incident or performance report. Where operational circumstances make this unavoidable, the fact shall be recorded and the report countersigned retrospectively by the next appointment in the chain of command within twenty-four (24) hours.

8.0 K9 Operational Categories

8.1 Land Security K9 Deployment

- Patrol K9s for intrusion detection, bush-line sweeps, tracking and compound protection.
- Detection K9s for the screening of vehicles, cargo, baggage and personnel at gates and access-control points.
- Emergency response support during civil disturbance, landowner tension or attempted sabotage of project assets, subject to Section 13 and to the express authority of the Security Operations Manager.
- Night patrols and early-warning perimeter surveillance, conducted in pairs with adequate lighting and communications.
- Post-incident search of routes, laydown areas and abandoned items.

8.2 Border Security K9 Deployment

- Screening of boats, convoys, foot patrol groups and cargo entering or departing KDP zones.
- Deployment at tactical checkpoints along rivers, tracks and access routes.
- Support to joint operations conducted with community leaders, provincial authorities and government agencies, subject to a documented liaison arrangement.
- Detection of smuggled goods, weapons, explosives, contraband and wildlife trafficking.
- Handlers shall not exercise powers of search, seizure or arrest reserved to statutory authorities. Where a detection indication occurs, the item and area shall be secured and the appropriate authority summoned.

8.3 Sea Marshal K9 Deployment

- Pre-departure vessel sweeps for weapons and explosives.
- Maritime interdiction support and anti-piracy deterrence.
- Search of cargo holds, containers, cabins, machinery spaces and fuel compartments, subject to confined-space and atmosphere clearance.
- Integration of the K9 team into ship boarding teams under the direction of the Sea Marshal.
- All maritime deployments require a canine flotation device, a documented dog-overboard recovery plan, shaded rest space and an uninterrupted supply of fresh drinking water.

8.4 PSD K9 Deployment

- Advance sweeps of venues, routes and accommodation for explosives and concealed weapons.
- Screening of meeting rooms, vehicles, gifts, freight and delegate baggage.
- Escort support during principal movements, positioned to preserve stand-off from the principal and the public.
- Deterrence and emergency protective response during hostile incidents.
- Only passive-indication detection K9s of stable temperament shall be employed in close proximity to principals, delegates or the public.

9.0 K9 Team Composition and Eligibility

9.1 Handler Requirements

- Certified K9 handling qualification appropriate to the discipline held (explosive detection, narcotic detection, patrol or dual-purpose).
- Valid PNG work permit and visa where applicable, and current KDP security clearance.
- Satisfactory criminal history check and verified employment references.
- Demonstrated physical fitness, discipline and emotional stability; annual medical fitness certification.
- Current first aid certification, including canine first aid.
- Mandatory pre-employment and quarterly random drug and alcohol testing, with additional testing following any bite or serious incident.
- A calm, consistent and controlled disposition around animals. Any evidence of harsh, punitive or abusive handling results in immediate removal from K9 duties pending investigation.
- Rabies and tetanus immunisation as advised by the attending medical officer, and completion of zoonotic disease awareness training.

9.2 Dog Requirements

- Only recognised working breeds or crosses of demonstrated suitability, including Belgian Malinois, German Shepherd, Dutch Shepherd, Labrador Retriever and Springer Spaniel.
- Minimum age of eighteen (18) months at first operational deployment; certification renewed at intervals not exceeding twelve (12) months.
- Documented temperament assessment covering noise tolerance, crowd exposure, vessel and helicopter movement, livestock neutrality and child presence.
- Microchipped, individually named and numbered, and recorded on the K9 asset register.
- Full vaccination status, parasite control and current veterinary fitness-for-duty certificate.
- Formal veterinary and NAQIA clearance prior to any movement into or within Papua New Guinea.

9.3 Team Pairing and Continuity

Each K9 shall be paired with a single primary handler to preserve the operational bond and reliability of indication. A designated secondary handler shall be nominated and maintained in familiarity for continuity during leave, illness or rotation. Unplanned re-pairing requires the written approval of the Kennel Master and a re-validation assessment before operational employment.

10.0 Acquisition, Onboarding and Contracted Providers

- All K9s shall be procured from reputable suppliers able to evidence lineage, health screening, prior training records and humane rearing practice.

- Each incoming K9 shall complete a documented acclimatisation period of not less than fourteen (14) days to adjust to tropical heat, humidity, terrain and site conditions before operational employment.
- Contracted K9 service providers shall demonstrate compliance with this policy as a condition of contract and are subject to Company audit at any time and without notice.
- Contracted providers shall carry public liability insurance expressly extending to injury caused by a working dog, and shall indemnify the Company accordingly.
- The Company shall maintain a K9 asset register recording, for each dog, its identity, chip number, discipline, certification status, handler assignment, medical history and service status.

11.0 Training and Certification

11.1 Initial Training

- A minimum of eight (8) to twelve (12) weeks of formal training, extended as required by the specialisation.
- Environment-specific conditioning for land, riverine, maritime and PSD roles, including vessel movement, engine noise, rotary-wing exposure and crowd density.
- All training shall meet recognised international standards, including IGP, PSA or NASDU, or an equivalent standard accepted in writing by the Company.
- Explosive and narcotic detection training shall use lawfully held, correctly stored and fully accounted training aids in accordance with Section 11.4.

11.2 Ongoing Training

- A minimum of eight (8) hours of structured refresher training per K9 team per week, recorded in the training log.
- Quarterly competency assessment conducted by the Kennel Master against the certification standard held.
- Annual external re-certification by an accredited independent assessor.
- Blind and double-blind detection validation trials conducted at least quarterly, with results retained as evidence of operational reliability.
- Scenario training addressing crowd management, community interface, vessel search and confined-space search.

11.3 Loss of Certification

A K9 team that fails an assessment, or whose certification lapses, shall be withdrawn from operational duty immediately. The team may be restored to duty only following remedial training and a documented successful re-assessment. Deployment of an uncertified team is a serious disciplinary matter.

11.4 Control of Training Aids

- Explosive and narcotic training aids shall be held under the authority of the relevant PNG regulator and stored in approved, segregated, alarmed and access-controlled containers.
- A dual-signature register shall record every issue, return, consumption and disposal of training aids, reconciled weekly by the Kennel Master and monthly by the Security Operations Manager.
- Any discrepancy in training aid accounting shall be reported immediately as a security incident and notified to the relevant authority.
- Training aids shall never be stored in accommodation, personal vehicles, kennel blocks or unsecured office space.

12.0 Operational Deployment Standards

12.1 General Rules

- A K9 shall remain under the positive control of its certified handler at all times.
- No K9 shall be deployed without the authorisation of the relevant Deployment Authority, recorded on the K9 Deployment Authorisation Form (Annex A).
- Collars, leads, harnesses, muzzles and vehicle restraints shall be inspected and signed for daily before deployment.
- K9s shall not be used to intimidate any person, and shall not be presented aggressively toward community members, protesters, employees or visitors.
- Handlers shall not consume alcohol within twelve (12) hours of duty and shall not deploy while fatigued, unwell or under the influence of impairing medication.
- A K9 shall not be handled, fed, exercised, disciplined or approached by any person other than its assigned handler or nominated secondary handler.

12.2 Duty Cycles, Heat and Fatigue Management

The tropical climate of Gulf Province presents a significant heat-stress risk to working dogs. The following limits are mandatory and may be tightened, but never relaxed, by the Kennel Master.

Condition	Maximum Continuous Work	Mandatory Rest and Control
Below 28°C	45 minutes	15 minutes shaded rest; water offered
28°C – 32°C	30 minutes	30 minutes shaded rest; water and body temperature check
Above 32°C or humidity above 85%	15 minutes	45 minutes in shade or cooled space; active cooling; deployment reviewed by Kennel Master
Night operations	45 minutes	15 minutes rest; lighting and communications confirmed

- Total operational working time shall not exceed six (6) hours in any twenty-four (24) hour period, excluding rest and transit.
- Each K9 shall receive not less than one (1) full rest day in every seven (7).
- Signs of heat stress — excessive panting, unsteady gait, bright red or pale gums, vomiting, collapse — require immediate cessation of work, active cooling and veterinary notification.
- Vehicles carrying K9s shall never be left stationary without ventilation, shade and a person in attendance.

12.3 Safety Protocols

- No K9 entry into a confined space without atmospheric testing, permit clearance and an extraction plan.
- Maritime deployment requires a canine flotation device, a specialised lifting harness and a rehearsed dog-overboard recovery drill.
- PSD deployment requires a defined crowd buffer to prevent accidental contact with principals or the public.
- K9s shall not be deployed into areas of known unexploded ordnance, chemical contamination, unstable structures or active fire without a specific written risk assessment.
- A canine first aid kit and a cooling kit shall accompany every deployed K9 team.

12.4 Transport

K9s shall be transported only in purpose-built, ventilated and secured compartments or approved transport cages. Transport in open trays, unsecured cargo areas or passenger footwells is prohibited. Water shall be offered at intervals not exceeding two (2) hours during road or river movement, and journey duration shall be recorded.

13.0 Use of Force and K9 Apprehension

13.1 Governing Principle

The deployment of a patrol K9 in an apprehension role constitutes a use of force. It shall comply with PNG law, the KDP Use of Force Policy and this Section. The lowest level of force reasonably necessary shall be used, for the shortest duration necessary, and shall cease the moment the threat is neutralised or resistance ends.

13.2 Graduated Response Model

Level	K9 Application	Authorisation
1	Presence — leashed, controlled, no verbal challenge.	Handler
2	Verbal warning with K9 present, in a language understood by the subject where practicable.	Handler
3	Controlled alert — barking on lead to induce compliance.	Senior Handler
4	Deployment on lead for apprehension of a person posing a serious threat.	Security Operations Manager or delegate
5	Off-lead deployment. Permitted only in defence of life where no reasonable alternative exists.	Security Operations Manager, recorded contemporaneously

13.3 Prohibited Uses

- Deployment against children, visibly pregnant women, the elderly or persons with evident disability, except in immediate defence of life.
- Deployment against a person who has surrendered, is restrained, is compliant, or is fleeing without posing a threat of serious harm.
- Deployment for the purpose of punishment, coercion, crowd dispersal, or as a means of extracting information.
- Deployment against a peaceful assembly, lawful protest or landowner gathering.
- Deployment in any manner intended to humiliate a person or to exploit cultural sensitivities.

13.4 Post-Incident Obligations

- Immediate first aid to any person bitten, and arrangement of professional medical treatment without delay and at Company cost where liability may attach.
- Preservation of the scene, retention of body-worn or CCTV footage, and collection of witness details.
- Verbal notification to the Security Operations Manager without delay; written K9 Bite and Use of Force Report (Annex B) within twelve (12) hours.
- Immediate stand-down of the K9 team from operational duty pending review.
- Veterinary assessment of the K9 and behavioural review by the Kennel Master.
- Notification of the client and, where required, of the relevant PNG authority.

14.0 Health, Welfare and Veterinary Care

Welfare standards are assessed against the Five Domains model: nutrition, physical environment, health, behavioural interaction and mental state. The following are minimum standards.

14.1 Nutrition and Hydration

- A veterinarian-approved diet appropriate to breed, workload and climate, fed on a documented daily schedule monitored by the Kennel Master.
- Clean, cool drinking water available at all times, including during land, riverine and maritime operations.
- No feeding within one (1) hour before, or one (1) hour after, strenuous work, to reduce the risk of gastric torsion.

14.2 Veterinary Care

- Routine veterinary examination at intervals not exceeding one (1) month, with findings recorded in the individual health file.
- A retained emergency veterinary capability on standby, with a documented medical evacuation route for serious canine injury.
- Vaccination, deworming, tick and flea control maintained to a current schedule appropriate to the tropical environment.
- Any K9 exhibiting injury, lameness, heat stress, gastrointestinal illness or behavioural change shall be withdrawn from duty pending veterinary assessment.

14.3 Behavioural and Psychological Welfare

- Daily free-exercise and enrichment periods separate from formal training.
- Positive-reinforcement methods only. Physical punishment, deprivation of food or water, prolonged isolation and the use of aversive devices are prohibited and constitute serious misconduct.
- Monitoring for signs of operational stress, including reluctance to work, loss of drive, appetite change or stereotypic behaviour, with mandatory rest periods where identified.

14.4 Kennelling and Housing

- Individual, secure, weatherproof kennels with solid shade, effective cross-ventilation, raised bedding and protection from flooding.
- Impervious flooring with drainage; kennels cleaned and disinfected daily and inspected weekly by the Kennel Master.
- Vector, rodent and snake control measures maintained around all kennel infrastructure.
- A quarantine or isolation kennel maintained for new arrivals and for any dog suspected of infectious disease.
- Contingency arrangements for kennel evacuation during flooding, fire, civil unrest or site emergency, rehearsed at least annually.

15.0 Equipment and Logistics

- Kennels, transport cages, dedicated K9 patrol vehicles and maritime safety equipment.
- Detection kits, search mirrors, torches, GPS trackers and canine first-aid and cooling kits.
- PSD-specific mobility harnesses, tactical collars, long-lines and quick-release equipment.
- Communications equipment issued to every deployed handler, with an established emergency call sign.
- All K9 equipment inspected daily, recorded on the equipment register, and withdrawn from service immediately upon defect.

- Muzzles shall be conditioned in training and shall not be used as a substitute for handler control.

16.0 Biosecurity and Disease Control

- All movement of K9s into, within or out of Papua New Guinea shall comply with NAQIA import, quarantine and certification requirements.
- New arrivals shall complete the prescribed quarantine and health observation period before entering the operational kennel block.
- Contact between Company K9s and community or stray dogs shall be avoided; any such contact shall be reported and the K9 assessed for disease exposure.
- Any suspected rabies, transmissible disease or notifiable condition shall be reported immediately to the attending veterinarian, the Kennel Master and the relevant PNG authority.
- Handlers shall observe hand hygiene, wound care and personal protective equipment requirements to manage zoonotic risk.

17.0 Incident Reporting, Investigation and Records

17.1 Reportable Events

- Aggression, uncontrolled behaviour or loss of handler control.
- Any bite, scratch or accidental contact involving a person, whether or not injury results.
- Injury to, illness of, escape of, or death of a K9.
- Equipment failure or defect affecting control or safety.
- Training deficiencies, missed refresher training or lapsed certification.
- Handler misconduct, welfare breach or suspected mistreatment.
- Discrepancies in training aid accounting.
- Operational outcomes, including detections, interdictions, recoveries and deterrence effects.

17.2 Timeframes

- Immediate verbal notification for any bite, serious injury, escape or death.
- Written report submitted within twelve (12) hours of the incident.
- Formal investigation commenced within twenty-four (24) hours for any bite or welfare breach, and concluded within seven (7) days.
- Findings, corrective actions and lessons learned circulated to all K9 personnel within fourteen (14) days.

17.3 Records

The Company shall maintain, in retrievable form, the K9 asset register, individual health and veterinary files, training and certification records, daily deployment and welfare logs, incident and investigation files, and training aid registers. Records shall be retained for a minimum of seven (7) years, or for the life of the dog plus three (3) years, whichever is longer, and shall be produced on lawful request.

18.0 Community and Landowner Engagement

The K9 capability operates within customary landowner areas in which dogs may hold cultural, practical or spiritual significance, and in which the sight of a working dog under handler control may be unfamiliar or perceived as threatening. Poorly managed K9 operations carry a disproportionate risk of community grievance. The following requirements are mandatory.

18.1 Prior Notification and Awareness

- The Community Liaison Officer shall brief landowner leadership and affected village representatives on the purpose, limits and control measures of the K9 capability before its introduction into any new operational area.
- Awareness materials shall be provided in Tok Pisin and, where practicable, in the relevant local language, explaining that Company K9s are trained working animals under handler control and are not deployed against communities.
- School and village awareness sessions shall be offered, emphasising that children must not approach or attempt to touch a working dog.

18.2 Conduct in and near Communities

- K9s shall be leashed and muzzled where appropriate whenever operating within or transiting a village, market, church, school or gathering place.
- K9s shall not be deployed at community meetings, negotiations, compensation payments or grievance forums.
- Handlers shall avoid contact between Company K9s and community dogs, pigs, poultry and other livestock, and shall route patrols accordingly.
- Photography of community members with K9s is prohibited without informed consent.

18.3 Cultural Sensitivity

- Handlers shall receive cultural induction covering local customs, taboos, land tenure and appropriate conduct, refreshed annually.
- Where a community identifies a specific cultural objection to K9 presence at a location, the objection shall be recorded and the deployment reviewed by the Security Operations Manager in consultation with the Community Liaison Officer.

18.4 Grievance, Injury and Compensation

- Any K9-related grievance shall be received through the KDP community grievance mechanism, acknowledged within forty-eight (48) hours, and resolved within twenty-one (21) days or with a documented reason for extension.
- Injury to any community member caused by a Company K9 shall trigger immediate medical assistance at Company cost, formal investigation, notification to the client and landowner leadership, and consideration of compensation in accordance with the KDP compensation framework and PNG law.
- Injury to community livestock caused by a Company K9 shall be investigated and settled in accordance with the same framework.
- A register of all K9-related grievances, outcomes and settlements shall be maintained and reported monthly to the Security Operations Manager.

18.5 National Capability Development

The Company is committed to the progressive training and certification of Papua New Guinean nationals, and preferentially of qualified candidates from KDP landowner communities, as K9 handlers. The Kennel Master shall maintain a national handler development plan with annual targets reported to the client.

18.6 Operating During Benefit-Sharing and Development Forum Periods

The registration of landowners, the incorporation of land groups (ILGs) and the distribution of project benefits under the Papua LNG development framework are recognised sources of community tension. During the Development Forum process, benefit or royalty distribution exercises, ILG registration, or any period of elevated landowner dispute, the Security Operations Manager shall review K9 tasking in the affected areas and shall reduce, re-route or suspend routine K9 deployment where its presence could inflame tension.

- K9 teams shall not be deployed at, or in the vicinity of, development forums, benefit or royalty payments, ILG meetings, compensation events or landowner protests.
- Where communities impose waterway or road closures, K9 river and land patrols shall be re-routed to avoid confrontation, and the matter referred to the Community Liaison Officer and provincial liaison arrangements rather than managed through canine presence.
- Landowner grievances shall be resolved primarily through engagement, de-escalation and the project grievance mechanism; the K9 capability is not a crowd-control or dispute-resolution instrument.
- The Security Operations Manager shall record each decision to deploy, restrict or suspend K9 activity during such periods, together with the supporting rationale.

19.0 Confidentiality, Media and Information Security

- All detection results, screening outcomes, PSD movement details, threat assessments and operational plans are classified and shall not be disclosed without written authority.
- No photograph, video, description or commentary relating to K9 operations shall be posted to social media or released to any media outlet by any employee.
- All media enquiries shall be referred, without comment, to the Managing Director or a nominated Company spokesperson.
- Deployment records and logs shall be stored securely, with access restricted to those with a demonstrable operational need.
- Unauthorised disclosure constitutes serious misconduct under the Zero-Tolerance Conduct, Ethics and Prohibited Behaviour Policy and may result in summary dismissal and legal action.

20.0 Retirement, Rehoming and End of Service

- Fitness for continued service shall be reviewed annually from the age of seven (7) years, and at any time on veterinary advice.
- A K9 shall be retired on grounds of age, chronic injury, loss of drive, sustained failure to certify, or veterinary recommendation.
- The retiring handler shall be given first option to adopt the retired K9, subject to a home suitability assessment.
- Where adoption by the handler is not possible, the K9 shall be rehomed to a screened and approved home or to a recognised working-dog retirement organisation.
- Euthanasia shall be considered only on veterinary advice for reasons of irremediable suffering or where the dog presents an unmanageable danger, and requires the written authorisation of the Security Operations Manager together with a written veterinary opinion.
- Abandonment, sale for fighting or baiting, transfer to an unassessed party, or disposal of a Company K9 by any informal means is strictly prohibited and constitutes gross misconduct.

21.0 Assurance, Audit and Performance Measurement

The Kennel Master shall report monthly, and the Security Operations Manager quarterly, against the following indicators:

Indicator	Target
Certification currency across all K9 teams	100%
Weekly refresher training hours completed	≥ 8 hours per team

Indicator	Target
Blind detection trial success rate	≥ 95%
Bite incidents involving community members	Zero
Welfare breaches recorded	Zero
Veterinary examinations completed on schedule	100%
Incident reports submitted within 12 hours	100%
K9-related grievances resolved within 21 days	≥ 95%
PNG national handlers as a proportion of the unit	Increasing year on year

- An internal audit of the K9 unit shall be conducted at least every six (6) months by a person independent of the unit.
- An independent external audit of welfare, certification and use-of-force compliance shall be conducted annually.
- The client reserves the right to audit K9 operations at any time on reasonable notice.

22.0 Non-Compliance and Disciplinary Action

Breach of this policy will be managed under the Zero-Tolerance Conduct, Ethics and Prohibited Behaviour Policy. The following are treated as gross misconduct and may result in summary dismissal, removal from PNG, and referral to the PNG authorities:

- Cruelty, neglect, or the use of punitive or aversive handling methods.
- Unauthorised or unlawful deployment of a K9 against a person.
- Falsification of training, welfare, certification, deployment or incident records.
- Loss, theft, diversion or unaccounted consumption of explosive or narcotic training aids.
- Deployment of a K9 while impaired by alcohol or drugs.
- Concealment or non-reporting of a bite, injury or welfare breach.

23.0 Training and Communication of this Policy

- All K9 personnel shall receive formal instruction on this policy at induction and annually thereafter, with attendance recorded.
- All KDP security personnel who work alongside K9 teams shall receive a familiarisation briefing covering safe conduct around working dogs.
- A signed acknowledgement of understanding shall be retained on the personnel file of every handler and supervisor.

24.0 Review Cycle

This policy shall be reviewed by the Document Owner and approved by the Managing Director:

- Annually, as a minimum.
- Following any significant incident, bite event, fatality or welfare breach.
- When KDP operational areas expand, contract or materially change.

- Upon the introduction of a new K9 capability, discipline or contracted provider.
- Upon any material change to PNG law, client requirements or applicable international standards.

Approval and Authorisation

This policy is issued under the authority of the Board of Southern Cross Strategic Holdings Pte Limited and takes effect from the date recorded below. It supersedes Version 2.0 – 2026 in its entirety.

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Prepared By — K9 Unit Supervisor (Kennel Master)			
Reviewed By — KDP Security Operations Manager			
Reviewed By — Group HSSE Manager			
Approved By — Managing Director			

Annex A — K9 Deployment Authorisation Form

Field	Entry
Date / Time of deployment	
K9 name and chip number	
Handler name and certification number	
Discipline (patrol / detection / dual)	
Task and location	
Operational category (Land / Border / Sea Marshal / PSD)	
Risk assessment reference	
Ambient temperature and humidity at commencement	
Equipment check completed (Y/N)	
Water and cooling kit carried (Y/N)	
Deployment Authority — name and signature	
Time completed / total working time	
Outcome and remarks	

Annex B — K9 Bite and Use of Force Report

Field	Entry
Date, time and precise location	
K9 and handler details	
Authorising officer	
Level of force applied (per Section 13.2)	
Description of the threat and justification	
Warnings given, and language used	
Details of person(s) involved	
Injuries sustained and first aid rendered	
Medical treatment arranged and by whom	
Witnesses and contact details	
Footage or evidence secured	
Client and authority notification made (time / person)	
K9 veterinary assessment outcome	
Handler statement attached (Y/N)	
Investigating officer and findings	

Annex C — Daily Kennel and Welfare Log

Check	Standard
Kennel cleaned and disinfected	Daily, recorded with time and initials
Water available, clean and cool	Verified at each check, minimum three times daily
Feed provided per schedule	Quantity and time recorded
Body condition, gait and coat	Visual assessment; abnormality escalated
Eyes, ears, teeth, paws and pads	Daily inspection, ticks and injuries recorded
Temperature and hydration after work	Recorded after every deployment above 28°C
Exercise and enrichment provided	Duration recorded
Behaviour and demeanour	Any change recorded and reported
Equipment condition	Serviceable / defective — defects reported immediately
Handler signature and Kennel Master verification	Daily and weekly respectively

Annex D — Certification and Currency Matrix

Requirement	Applies To	Frequency	Verified By
External re-certification	K9 team	Annually	Accredited assessor
Internal competency assessment	K9 team	Quarterly	Kennel Master
Blind detection validation	Detection K9	Quarterly	Kennel Master
Refresher training	K9 team	Weekly (8 hrs)	Senior Handler
Veterinary examination	K9	Monthly	Attending Veterinarian
Vaccination and parasite control	K9	Per schedule	Attending Veterinarian
Temperament re-assessment	K9	Annually	Kennel Master
Drug and alcohol testing	Handler	Quarterly / random	HSSE Manager
Medical fitness certification	Handler	Annually	Medical Officer
First aid and canine first aid	Handler	Every 2 years	Training Provider
Cultural induction refresher	Handler	Annually	Community Liaison Officer
Use of force refresher	Handler	Annually	Security Operations Manager

END OF POLICY